

Power Tips

Inkjet printer

- It is very important to align the ink cartridge properly when you install it the first time. The software that comes along with the printer allows you to do this. All you have to do is click on the 'Align' button and the printer will automatically align the ink cartridges.
- Store the cartridges in the right packaging: Always store extra cartridges in their factory-supplied containers. If you regularly switch between colour and black ink, store the swapped-out cartridge in an old factory-supplied container or in a small, zip-lock bag.
- Always use your printer's power switch rather than the switch on a surge protector to switch off your printer.
- To avoid paper jams, clean the rollers and the internal mechanism with mild alcohol. Set the paper guides carefully when placing the paper in the tray for printing.
- The outside of the printer can be cleaned by spraying a mild glass cleaner on a soft cloth.
- Use the right paper. Most ink jets print reasonably well on standard A4 paper. However, the type of paper you use strongly affects the quality of inkjet output. Some grades of paper absorb too much ink, causing images to be either too light or too blurred. If you want the best image possible, use the paper recommended by your printer manufacturer.
- While printing photos, use manufacturer-recommended photo paper or the ink won't dry and the results won't live up to your expectations.
- Over a period of time, the prints you get will become faint and you will see lines running across the page. To restore the original print quality, many inkjets come with a nozzle cleaning function that blows ink through the nozzle and unclogs it. Use this feature on a regular basis if you use your printer only once in two weeks.
- For optimum and trouble-free performance, always insist on an original ink cartridge. Do not get them refilled to save money.
- Never shake the ink cartridge as this can create bubbles. Air bubbles in the cartridge can cause the printer to shut down.
- If you find ink leaking, do not attempt to open the printer. Call an authorised service person immediately.
- Don't place the paper stack in the tray without separating them as it could lead to paper jams.

Laser printer

- Select the proper location to place your laser printer. A properly ventilated area is recommended. Select a place where temperature

and humidity do not change rapidly. Try to avoid areas with heavy dust build-up.

- Position the printer on a sturdy and level surface, and allow sufficient space around the printer for air flow.
- Always use a lightly dampened cloth to clean the outside of the printer. To clean the inside, use a dry, lint-free cloth. This will ensure that no liquid enters the innards of the printer. Most manufacturers provide useful cleaning information on their manuals, so refer to them.
- Use paper that's been manufactured specifically for your printer, and select the correct paper type for your print job.
- Keep your printer up-to-date by downloading the latest drivers and patches from the manufacturer's Web site. This helps because most manufacturers provide driver updates for your unit, including patches that add fonts or correct incompatibilities.
- If debris is the primary cause of failure, toner is the primary cause of debris. All toner cartridges will release a small amount of toner into the machine. This is why it's important to clean the machine when you change the cartridge. It is important that the density control of the machine is properly set, to prevent the machine from pulling too much toner. We all like dark prints, but if your print settings are too dark, it could be detrimental to the life of the cartridge in the long run.
- Don't pile documents or miscellaneous objects on top of your printer, as they could damage it. Your printer may overheat and this could result in malfunctioning, and even a reduction in the printer life.



Smart Printing

A printer doesn't print only boring old text. You can go ahead and print pretty much anything you want.

You can print multiple copies of the same document without giving a print command each time. Whenever you select the Print option from the File menu or a printer icon, a small printer dialog box opens up. Here, under the 'Number of copies', just increase it to the number you want printed.

Are you one of those who head straight for the print command when you see something you like on a Web page?

Well, consider this. You can easily select specific parts of your document, so you don't have to print it entirely. This can obviously be helpful in saving ink. To do this, simply select the area or the part of the document you want to print. Now, in the print dialog box just choose Selection in under the Page range. Now your printout won't have banner ads or pictures that are of no use to you.

Many times it happens that you want to print at a lower resolution to save ink, or you want to print on both sides on the



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